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Book Review - *Computer Geek to Cult Icon*
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Steve Wozniak's book was first released on September 25, 2006, by W.W. Norton & Company Ltd. The title of the book is *iWOZ, Computer Geek to Cult Icon*. I first learned about this book in the San Jose Mercury News on September 24, 2006. The book caught my attention because it was written by the Apple co-founder Steve Wozniak. Wozniak engineered the Apple I in 1975 (pg. 168) and the Apple II in 1976 (pg. 186). Wozniak also mentioned the young Bill Gates, who had written a BASIC interpreter for the Altair (pg. 168).

I'm still fascinated by the Apple I/II computer. In addition, I am also a huge fan of the new iMac and iPod. I will always remember that my first personal computer was Apple I and my first programming language was BASIC.

Steve Wozniak talked a lot about his father and how he taught him the meaning of honesty and ethical conduct, as well as electronics. Just from the first chapter, I have a lot of respect for him. He said even today, his father's words were still very much alive. He remembered his father once saying, "I'm a man of my word." I think Steve Wozniak is trying to model himself after a man of character and integrity, just as his father once was. Wozniak dedicated his book to his parents. Personally, I have a lot of respect for people who value their parents. My father is my hero.

At six years old, Steve Wozniak built his first electronic device, a crystal radio, and was already way ahead of other kids his age. By sixth grade, he built a Halli Craftsman transmitter and receiver, and these skills later helped Wozniak design and assemble the Apple I. I think that Wozniak is an electronics whiz kid.

The greatest strength of Wozniak's book is that he describes himself as the accidental success story. I think that this book may be good for K-12 students. Wozniak's words may inspire students to pursue science, mathematics, and engineering. This book is also a good book for anyone who loves new technology for the sense of discovery, not the profits.

The weakness of Wozniak's book is that there are too many technical terms and too many lower-level electronics—resistor, transistor, transceiver, transmitter, and so on—which may be difficult for a non-technical reader.

Generally speaking, Wozniak's book is for anyone who needs a little bit of inspiration and motivation to pursue their career dreams. Wozniak said, "owning a computer had been a lifetime dream of mine."

Wozniak wanted to do something good for the planet and all the people on it. This was the kind of engineer that Wozniak wanted to become. Wozniak said, "I wanted to do—build something that would end up allowing me to do something really good for people" (pg. 26). I think Wozniak has succeeded even beyond his wildest dreams. Looking at Apple Computer today, one can see his creation is used everywhere.

Like Bill Gates, Wozniak knows what he is talking about. Both Bill Gates and Steve Wozniak are technical geniuses, but Bill Gates is not only technologically smart but also business- and marketing-smart. In addition, Wozniak also mentioned Steve Jobs as the tech evangelist and visionary.

All in all, I paid \$25.99 for Steve Wozniak's book, and it was worth the price. I've learned a lot from Wozniak and his father, whom he describes as the single greatest influence on his life and on what he has become today.

Lastly, just as Wozniak's father, I hope to leave a legacy to my son by helping him understand things like "light" and how a lightbulb works.

References

Wozniak, Steve (2006). *Computer Geek to Cult Icon*, W.W. Norton & Company Ltd.,
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